E Learn English *with Emma*

WORKBOOK

The Speaking *Guide*

Phrases, sounds and a 30-day plan to help you speak English with confidence.

1
A daily speaking routine

30
small talk phrases

8
sound pairs to practise

30
days, 15 minutes each

PART 1

How to use this guide

Most students don't need more grammar. They need more practice saying things out loud, and a way to notice their own mistakes. This guide gives you both. Use it before class, after class, and on the days in between.

The 3-step speaking routine

Do this for 15 minutes a day. It works better than one long session a week.

1

Say it

Pick one question from the list below and answer it out loud for one minute. Don't stop to fix mistakes. Keep going.

2

Record it

Answer the same question again and record yourself on your phone. Listen back once.

3

Fix one thing

Choose one thing to improve: a word, a sound or a sentence. Say the answer a third time with that one fix.

Questions to answer

What did you do last weekend?	What's your job, and what do you like about it?
Describe the place where you live.	What's something you learned recently?
Tell me about a good meal you had.	What would you change about your city?

> **Tip from Emma:** Speak first, check later. If you stop to translate every sentence, you practise translating, not speaking.

PART 2

30 phrases for small talk

Learn these as whole phrases, not word by word. Say each one out loud three times.

Starting

1. How's your week going?
2. Have you been busy today?
3. Did you do anything nice at the weekend?
4. How do you know Sam?
5. Is this your first time here?
6. That looks good. What is it?
7. How was the traffic this morning?
8. Have you worked here long?
9. I love your bag. Where's it from?
10. Lovely weather today, isn't it?

Keeping it going

1. Oh really? How come?
2. That sounds fun. What was the best part?
3. I know what you mean.
4. Me too. / Me neither.
5. What made you choose that?
6. How did that go?
7. That's interesting. Tell me more.
8. I've never tried that. Is it hard?
9. Sorry, could you say that again?
10. So what's next for you?

Leaving politely

1. It was really nice talking to you.
2. I'd better get going.
3. I'll let you get back to work.
4. Let's catch up properly soon.
5. Good luck with the interview.
6. Enjoy the rest of your day.
7. See you on Monday.
8. Say hi to your family for me.
9. Let me know how it goes.
10. Take care. Bye for now.

Practice: Pick one phrase from each column. Use all three in a real conversation this week, at work, in a shop or on a call.

PART 3

Sounds that matter

You don't need a perfect accent. You need to be easy to understand. These sound pairs cause the most confusion.

Sound pair	Say the difference	Try this sentence
ship / sheep	short "i" / long "ee"	The sheep are on the ship.
live / leave	short "i" / long "ee"	I live here, but I leave at six.
full / fool	short "u" / long "oo"	Don't be a fool, the cup is full.
bed / bad	"e" / open "a"	A bad night in a hard bed.
think / sink	tongue between teeth for "th"	I think the sink is broken.
very / berry	top teeth on lip for "v"	A very big berry.
light / right	tongue up for "l", back for "r"	Turn right at the light.
walk / work	"aw" / "er"	I walk to work.

Word stress

Put the stress on the right part of the word and people understand you, even if a sound is not perfect.

PHOtograph	pho**TO**graphy	photo**GRA**phic
PREsent (a gift)	pre**SENT** (to show)	presen**TA**tion
COMfortable	**VE**getable	**IN**teresting

> **Tip from Emma:** Record the sentences above, then listen with your eyes closed. Which words are hard to hear? Practise only those.

PART 4

Your 30-day plan

15 minutes a day. Tick each day when you finish.

Week	Focus	Every day
Week 1	Speaking without stopping	The 3-step routine with one question from Part 1
Week 2	Small talk	Learn 5 phrases from Part 2 and use 2 of them
Week 3	Sounds	Record two sound pairs from Part 3 and fix one
Week 4	Putting it together	Talk for two minutes about your day, then record it
Days 29 and 30	Look back	Listen to your first recording and your last. Notice the difference.

Before your live class

- [ ] Test Zoom and your headphones
- [ ] Write one situation where English is hard for you
- [ ] Have this guide open
- [ ] Keep a notebook for new phrases
- [ ] Join five minutes early
- [ ] Turn notifications off for an hour

Practise with Emma, live

Small classes on Zoom, 12 students at most. **$35 per class**, or the 8-week course with two classes a week. Book at the class page or reply to any of Emma's emails.